

Sega Saturn – Fenrir Guide

Step-by-step guide, very easy to follow, so anyone can use Fenrir without knowing technology.

Recommended Links

-  Official Fenrir Firmware:

[Download official firmware](#)

Always download the firmware from here. It is the official website of the Fenrir creator.

-  Recommended videos – Retro Game Corps:

[Fenrir guides on YouTube – Retro Game Corps](#)

If you get lost at any step, you can watch the process here.

Recommended Material

Before starting, make sure you have everything ready:



MicroSD 128GB (Amazon)



Fenrir ODE (AliExpress)

- ✓ A working Sega Saturn.
- ✓ A Fenrir compatible with your model (20-pin, 21-pin or Duo).
- ✓ A MicroSD card (preferably 32–128GB, from a known brand).
- ✓ A Phillips screwdriver to open the console.
- ✓ A PC or laptop to copy files to the MicroSD.

LEGAL NOTICE: This guide is intended for using backups of games you already own physically or free software. It does not support or explain how to download games illegally.

What is Fenrir?

Fenrir is a device that replaces the Sega Saturn's CD drive. Instead of inserting discs, you use a MicroSD card with your legal games.

You can think of it as a "digital disc reader":

- ✓ It doesn't break like old CD drives.
- ✓ Games load much faster.
- ✓ No need to swap discs.
- ✓ Everything runs from the MicroSD.

Compatibility – Saturn Types

Your Saturn can be one of two main types:

- 🍷 **20-pin** – Older models.
- 🍷 **21-pin** – Newer models.
- 🟩 **Fenrir Duo** – Works with both.

If you don't know which one you have:

👉 Open the console and look at the CD drive connector. Count the pins: 20 or 21.

1 Prepare the MicroSD

We will prepare the card so Fenrir works on the first try.

1. Connect the MicroSD to the PC (with adapter if needed).
2. Format the MicroSD:
 - If 64GB or more → **exFAT**.
 - If 32GB or less → **FAT32** or exFAT.
3. Download the `update.bin` file from the official website.
4. Copy it to the root of the MicroSD (no folders).
5. Create folders for your games if you want to keep things organized.

2 Install Fenrir in the Saturn

Now we will replace the CD drive with Fenrir. Do it calmly.

1. Turn off the Saturn and disconnect all cables.
2. Remove the screws from the bottom.
3. Lift the top shell.
4. Disconnect the data ribbon and power cable from the drive.
5. Remove the original CD drive.
6. Place Fenrir in its position.
7. Connect the data ribbon to Fenrir (straight and aligned).
8. Connect power if your model requires it.

3 First Boot with Fenrir

Now we will turn on the Saturn with Fenrir installed.

1. Insert the MicroSD into Fenrir.
2. Close the console and reinstall the screws.
3. Connect power and video.
4. Turn on the console.
5. Fenrir will update the firmware automatically.
6. You will see the menu with your folders and games.
7. Select a game and press **A** to boot.

```
FENRIR LOADER v1.6.0
-----
> [DIR] Games
- Sega Rally.iso
- Panzer Dragoon.cue

[A] Boot [C] Settings
```

Common Errors and Solutions

The Saturn shows “Checking Disc”:

The console does not detect Fenrir.

- ✓ Check the data ribbon.
- ✓ Make sure no pins are bent.
- ✓ Ensure Fenrir is properly seated.

No games appear:

- ✓ MicroSD not inserted correctly.
- ✓ Games in incompatible format.
- ✓ Games inside too many nested folders.

Useful Tips

- 🌐 Fenrir is multi-region.
- 🧩 Use a 3D-printed mount so it doesn't move.
- ⚡ Organize your folders for faster loading.
- 💾 Back up your MicroSD.